

8:11	31	κατακρινω	κατακρινω	**κρινω / κατακρινω
8:11	32	και απο του νυν	και απο του νυν/ απο του νυν και	**και

M⁷ has a single, clear-cut, unambiguous profile/mosaic, as defined by 127 MSS—there is no internal variation among them (the 127 are precisely the same for all twelve verses). This contrasts dramatically with **M**⁶ and **M**⁵. It is possible to come up with a partial profile for both **5** and **6**, for purposes of distinguishing them from each other and from **7**, but they have so much internal variation that I see no way to come up with a family archetype that is objectively defined. I used ** to distinguish variants that might be called the ‘backbone’ of the family, for the purpose of distinguishing it from the others. As the reader can verify, **6** has internal division no less than 15 times out of 32, which does not improve its credibility quotient. **5** has ‘only’ four, so it is far less ‘squishy’ than **6**, but the nature of those four does not allow a single archetypal form. (I did not include set 13 in the above because there is generalized confusion among the MSS.)

Now then, **7** and **6** join against **5** fourteen times; **7** and **5** join against **6** nine times; **6** and **5** join against **7** not one single time. Does this mean that **7** is dependent on **5** and **6** (von Soden), or does it mean that **5** and **6** are independent departures from **7** (WNP)? Only for set 23 are all three groups entirely distinct, but at least for this set **7** does not depend on the other two. (Curiously, the MSS present us with at least seven different arrangements of the five words in set 23, and the main lectionary group goes with a fourth reading, not one of the big three.) To my mind, **7** is the lowest common denominator, and therefore older and better than the other two. So what is the point? The point is that **M**⁷ equals von Soden’s **K**^r (my **f**³⁵), and he used his analysis of **M**⁷ to characterize his **K**^r for the whole NT! He repeatedly offered **M**⁷ as ‘proof’ that **K**^r was late. As anyone who is even remotely acquainted with the MSS knows, to characterize even one book, not to mention the whole NT, on the basis of twelve verses is just plain wrong.¹

5. For some mysterious reason von Soden seemed determined that his **K**^r should have been created in the XII century, so he exerted himself to re-date the three **K**^r MSS from the XI that he knew of. But since the three are copies, not original creations, their exemplars were older, of necessity (as were the exemplars of the exemplars), so what did von Soden think he was ‘proving’? To his mind, apparently, a

¹ Since it is impossible to demonstrate objectively that **M**⁷ is dependent on **M**⁶ and **M**⁵, that imagined dependency should not be alleged as being relevant to the age and nature of the text-type.